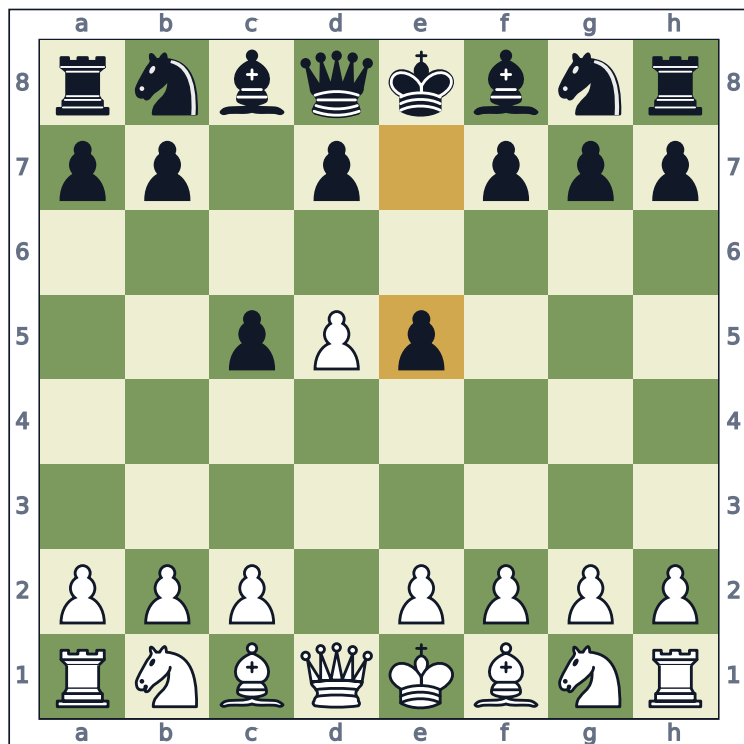


FLEXIBLE QUEEN'S PAWN AND INDIAN SETUPS

Benoni Defense

ECO A44 | 2 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Risky for Black with best play. Use it only with concrete preparation or as a surprise weapon.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+1.22 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

A44 covers Benoni Defense. White establishes d4 while both sides keep several pawn structures available. The diagram uses the featured line Benoni Defense: Old Benoni.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 c5 2. d5 e5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Support d4, complete development, and choose c4, e4, or a system setup according to Black's placement.

BLACK'S GOALS

Pressure d4, prevent an effortless e4 center, and choose a timely ...d5, ...c5, or ...e5 challenge.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

The position is usually defined by c4/c5 or e4/e5. The side that prepares the break better gains the initiative.

PIECE MAP

Knights fight for e4 and d5; bishops should be developed according to the final pawn chain rather than by habit. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Automatic system moves can miss a tactical change in the center or allow the opponent an ideal break. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on c5, White pawn on d5, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A strong practical family for players who want flexibility and familiar structures against several defenses.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named A44 line

This section preserves all 2 names and defining routes assigned to A44 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 **Benoni Defense: Old Benoni**
1. d4 c5 2. d5 e5

002 **Benoni Defense: Semi-Benoni**
1. d4 c5 2. d5 e5 3. e4 d6